

D351

Functions of Human Resource Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A hospital projects it will need 320 nurses next year. It has 300 now and expects 10 percent turnover, with no hires yet planned. HR tracks this on a new analytics dashboard, and the hospital was recently ranked in the region's top 10. What is the projected staffing gap?

- A. A shortage of 50 nurses.
- B. A shortage of 20 nurses.
- C. A shortage of 30 nurses.
- D. A surplus of 50 nurses.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm needs 170 technicians next year. It expects to lose 20 percent of its current technicians and make no hires, leaving a gap of 30. How many technicians does it have now?

- A. 140
- B. 200
- C. 175
- D. 168

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A retailer began the year with 180 employees and ended with 220. During the year, 40 employees left. The company also opened two stores and launched a loyalty app. What is its annual turnover rate?

- A. 20%
- B. 500%
- C. 22.2%
- D. 18.2%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company's turnover rate was 15 percent on an average headcount of 400. How many employees separated?

- A.** 15
- B.** 27
- C.** 340
- D.** 60

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

An HR specialist observes shifts and records that forklift operators must hold a forklift certification and be able to lift 50 pounds. The warehouse is 400,000 square feet and runs three shifts. Where do the certification and lifting requirement belong?

- A.** The job description.
- B.** The facilities plan, because of the warehouse size.
- C.** The performance appraisal form.
- D.** The job specification.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A tech company needs a new director of cybersecurity quickly and wants someone who already knows its systems and culture. Two internal managers have led major security projects. The company's stock rose 8 percent last quarter. What is the main advantage of promoting from within here?

- A.** It is always cheaper and always produces better leaders.
- B.** Faster ramp-up and a proven track record inside the company.
- C.** It brings in new ideas from other companies.
- D.** The stock gain means it can afford an outside search firm.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A company learns that its senior accountants earn \$78,000, while salary surveys show \$92,000 for the role in its city. Their pay is in line with other jobs at the same level inside the company. The accountants work in a newly renovated office. What problem does the company have?

- A. Internal equity.
- B. Pay compression.
- C. External competitiveness.
- D. None, because the renovated office makes up the difference.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A firm pays at market rates, but a warehouse supervisor earns less than the forklift operators she supervises. Which principle is violated?

- A. No principle, since market rates are paid.
- B. Internal equity.
- C. Minimum wage law.
- D. External competitiveness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Three months after a customer-service training, a company checks whether trainees actually use the new de-escalation steps on live calls. The training was held at a lakeside resort and rated 4.8 out of 5 by participants. Which Kirkpatrick level is being measured?

- A. Level 1, reaction.
- B. Level 2, learning.
- C. Level 3, behavior.
- D. Level 4, results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Several nonunion employees at a distribution center discuss staffing in a group chat and then jointly ask management for better break schedules. The center has 600 workers and just installed an automated sorter. A manager wants to discipline them. What is the main legal issue?

- A.** The NLRA protects only union members.
- B.** Their joint action is likely protected concerted activity under the NLRA, even without a union.
- C.** Employers can always discipline employees for group chats.
- D.** The new sorter changes their legal protection.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A plant had 6 recordable injuries last year, and its employees worked 300,000 hours. The plant manager has 20 years of experience, and the plant passed an insurance audit. What is its total recordable incident rate?

- A.** 2.0
- B.** 9.0
- C.** 0.00002
- D.** 4.0

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company's total recordable incident rate was 3.0 last year, with 400,000 hours worked. How many recordable cases did it have?

- A.** 6
- B.** 1.5
- C.** 3
- D.** 12

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A hospital projects it will need 320 nurses next year. It has 300 now and expects 10 percent turnover, with no hires yet planned. ~~HR tracks this on a new analytics dashboard, and the hospital was recently ranked in the region's top 10.~~ What is the projected staffing gap?

Target word: projected gap **Decides:** Supply after turnover = $300 \times 0.90 = 270$.

A	Correct	$320 - 270 = 50$.
B	Dropped element	$320 - 300$ ignores turnover.
C	Wrong stem number	That is the number expected to leave, not the gap.
D	Inverted operation	Subtracts demand from supply; the hospital is short.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A firm needs 170 technicians next year. It expects to lose 20 percent of its current technicians and make no hires, leaving a gap of 30. How many technicians does it have now?

Target word: solve for current headcount **Decides:** Supply after losses = $170 - 30 = 140 = 0.80 \times \text{current}$.

A	Dropped element	That is supply after turnover, not the current count.
B	Wrong stem number	Adds the gap to demand.
C	Correct	$140 \div 0.80 = 175$.
D	Inverted operation	140×1.20 adds 20 percent to the remainder instead of dividing by 0.80.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A retailer began the year with 180 employees and ended with 220. During the year, 40 employees left. ~~The company also opened two stores and launched a loyalty app.~~ What is its annual turnover rate?

Target word: turnover rate **Decides:** Average headcount = $(180 + 220) \div 2 = 200$.

A	Correct	$40 \div 200 = 20\%$.
B	Inverted operation	$200 \div 40$ flips the ratio.
C	Wrong stem number	$40 \div 180$ uses the beginning headcount.
D	Dropped element	$40 \div 220$ drops the beginning headcount from the average.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A company's turnover rate was 15 percent on an average headcount of 400. How many employees separated?

Target word: solve for separations **Decides:** Separations = 0.15×400 .

A	Wrong stem number	The percentage, not a head count.
B	Inverted operation	$400 \div 15$ divides instead of multiplying.
C	Confusion set	That is the number who stayed.
D	Correct	$400 \times 0.15 = 60$.

5. Answer D Concept 3

An HR specialist observes shifts and records that forklift operators must hold a forklift certification and be able to lift 50 pounds. ~~The warehouse is 400,000 square feet and runs three shifts.~~ Where do the certification and lifting requirement belong?

Target word: which document **Decides:** Qualifications a person must have.

A	Confusion set	Descriptions list duties and tasks.
B	Camouflage	Building size does not decide where person requirements go.
C	Adjacent category	Appraisals rate how well someone performs.
D	Correct	Specifications list required qualifications and abilities.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A tech company needs a new director of cybersecurity quickly and wants someone who already knows its systems and culture. Two internal managers have led major security projects. ~~The company's stock rose 8 percent last quarter.~~ What is the main advantage of promoting from within here?

Target word: internal hiring advantage **Decides:** Speed and known fit.

A	Absolute language	Internal hiring has trade-offs.
B	Correct	Insiders know the systems and their performance is known.
C	Inverted operation	That is an advantage of external hiring.
D	Camouflage	Stock performance does not decide the advantage asked about.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A company learns that its senior accountants earn \$78,000, while salary surveys show \$92,000 for the role in its city. Their pay is in line with other jobs at the same level inside the company. ~~The accountants work in a newly renovated office.~~ What problem does the company have?

Target word: type of pay problem **Decides:** Below market; internally consistent.

A	Inverted operation	The stem says internal comparisons are fine.
B	Adjacent category	Compression is new hires earning close to veterans.
C	Correct	Pay trails the market even though it is fair internally.
D	Camouflage	Office upgrades do not close a \$14,000 market gap.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

A firm pays at market rates, but a warehouse supervisor earns less than the forklift operators she supervises. Which principle is violated?

Target word: principle violated — reverse case **Decides:** Pay order inside the firm is wrong.

A	Dropped element	Drops the internal comparison.
B	Correct	Pay across jobs inside the firm does not reflect their relative worth.
C	Adjacent category	Nothing suggests anyone is below the legal minimum.
D	Inverted operation	The firm is at market.

9. Answer C Concept 6

Three months after a customer-service training, a company checks whether trainees actually use the new de-escalation steps on live calls. ~~The training was held at a lakeside resort and rated 4.8 out of 5 by participants.~~ Which Kirkpatrick level is being measured?

Target word: Kirkpatrick level **Decides:** On-the-job use of skills.

A	Camouflage	The 4.8 rating is reaction, but that is not what is being measured now.
B	Confusion set	Learning is measured by tests at the end of training.
C	Correct	It measures transfer to the job.
D	Adjacent category	Results are business outcomes like complaints or retention.

10. Answer B Concept 7

Several nonunion employees at a distribution center discuss staffing in a group chat and then jointly ask management for better break schedules. ~~The center has 600 workers and just installed an automated sorter.~~ A manager wants to discipline them. What is the main legal issue?

Target word: legal issue **Decides:** Joint action on working conditions.

A	Dropped element	Drops the protection for nonunion employees.
B	Correct	The NLRA protects most private-sector workers acting together.
C	Absolute language	Protected discussions cannot be punished.
D	Camouflage	Equipment does not decide NLRA coverage.

11. Answer D Concept 8

A plant had 6 recordable injuries last year, and its employees worked 300,000 hours. ~~The plant manager has 20 years of experience, and the plant passed an insurance audit.~~ What is its total recordable incident rate?

Target word: incident rate **Decides:** $6 \times 200,000 \div 300,000$.

A	Adjacent category	Uses a 100,000-hour base instead of 200,000.
B	Inverted operation	$6 \times 300,000 \div 200,000$ flips the hours.
C	Dropped element	$6 \div 300,000$ leaves out the 200,000 normalizer.
D	Correct	$1,200,000 \div 300,000 = 4.0$.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A company's total recordable incident rate was 3.0 last year, with 400,000 hours worked. How many recordable cases did it have?

Target word: solve for cases **Decides:** $\text{Cases} = 3.0 \times 400,000 \div 200,000$.

A	Correct	$3.0 \times 2 = 6$.
B	Inverted operation	$3.0 \times 200,000 \div 400,000$ flips the ratio.
C	Wrong stem number	The rate, not the case count.
D	Adjacent category	Uses a 100,000-hour base.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	5	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Workforce planning gap	Gap = forecast demand – projected supply, where supply is current staff minus expected losses plus planned additions.	Comparing demand to today's headcount and ignoring turnover.	A future headcount target plus a turnover percentage.
2	Turnover rate	Turnover rate = separations ÷ average headcount × 100, where average = (beginning + ending) ÷ 2.	Dividing by beginning or ending headcount alone.	Beginning and ending headcounts plus a number who left.
3	Job description vs. job specification	Job analysis produces a job description (duties and tasks) and a job specification (qualifications a person needs).	Putting certifications and physical requirements in the description.	"Must hold," "able to lift," or required credentials.
4	Internal vs. external recruiting	Internal hiring is faster, cheaper to onboard, and uses known performance; external hiring brings new skills and ideas.	Listing "fresh ideas" as an advantage of promoting from within.	"Knows our culture" vs. "new perspective."
5	Internal equity vs. external competitiveness	Internal equity compares pay across jobs inside the firm (job evaluation); external competitiveness compares pay to the market (salary surveys).	Treating any pay complaint as an internal-equity problem.	Market survey data (external) vs. comparisons among the firm's own jobs (internal).
6	Kirkpatrick evaluation levels	Level 1 reaction, Level 2 learning, Level 3 behavior on the job, Level 4 business results.	Treating high satisfaction scores as proof the training worked.	What was measured: ratings, test scores, on-the-job use, or business outcomes.
7	Protected concerted activity	The NLRA protects most private-sector employees, union or not, who act together about pay or working conditions.	Thinking only union members are protected.	Nonunion employees jointly raising a workplace issue.
8	OSHA incident rate	Total recordable incident rate = recordable cases × 200,000 ÷ total hours worked.	Using 100,000 as the base or flipping the ratio.	A count of injuries and total hours worked.

Course scope (public description): Human resource management is where strategy and people come together. This course introduces you to the full scope of HR functions, including workforce planning, talent acquisition, compensation, employee development, labor relations, and workplace safety. By understanding how these functions work together, you will see how HR professionals influence both business results and the employee experience.